

Artie Ficial



Your grievance with Grant

Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Your other secret

You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Monet has seen the governance addendum.
3. Quietly learn whether Claire would stay if you left.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Round 1 / Motive

When questioned, read your answer. It is the same whether you are innocent or the murderer.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum and my resignation within sixty days. He called that a gift. I called it a takeover. I had not agreed to surrender my museum or my job.

Your next action

Ask the next seated guest their named Motive question in the question catalog. Note one grievance that might matter. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 2 / Opportunity

When questioned, read the answer for your role. Keep the section labels to yourself.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, correcting Grant's speech cards. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the podium polish stored inside.

IF MURDERER

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:47, correcting Grant's speech cards. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the podium polish stored inside.

After answering, ask the next seated guest their named Opportunity question in the catalog. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 3 / Method

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: IF INNOCENT = Card B; IF MURDERER = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

When questioned, read your answer below, then your selected receipt. Leave the unused card hidden.

IF INNOCENT

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for rescuing a champagne-spotted gala program. That was what the materials desk issued me.

IF MURDERER

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for rescuing a champagne-spotted gala program. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Put the read receipt on the Evidence Table. Discuss, then vote privately. The host will distribute FINALE envelopes only after collecting all ballots.